

SILONIS AND TETHERON

JULY 30, 2026



I induced lucidity through sleep paralysis and found myself in a modern city much like the waking world.



I imagined that I could bring only one of my two primary dream artifacts home with me.



The Rainbow Crystal Life Sword seemed like the obvious choice.



It could heal injuries, bring objects to life, purify evil beings, and protect me inside powerful force fields.



I could even ride it through the air, giving me the flight and durability of a flying-brick superhero.



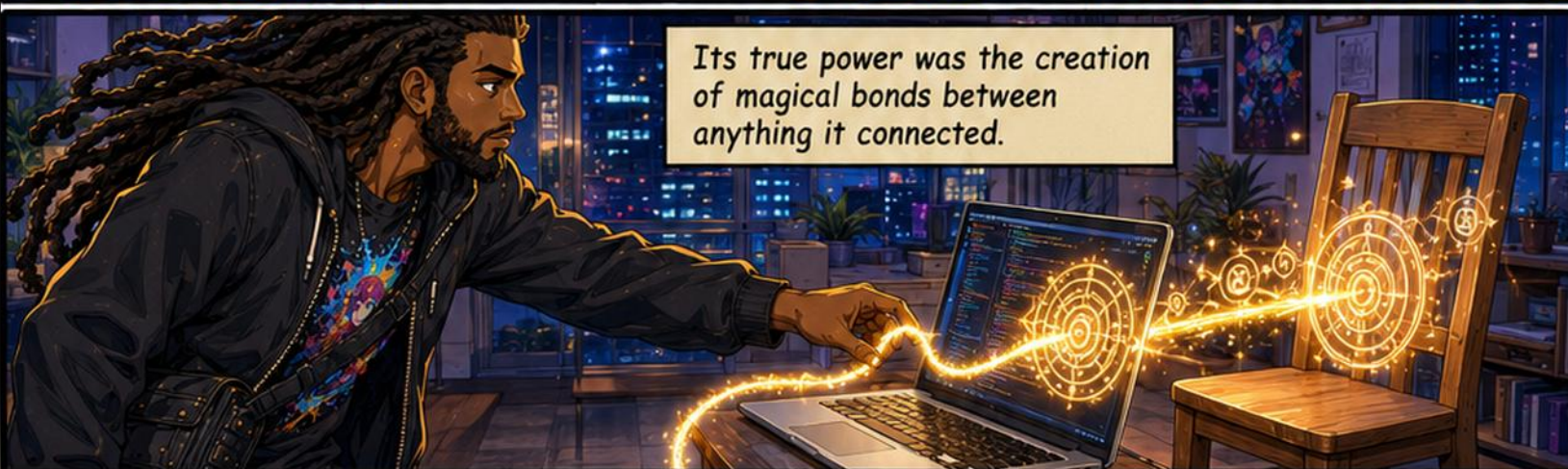
But the sword was already alive and able to speak with me. Leaving it behind would mean abandoning a companion.



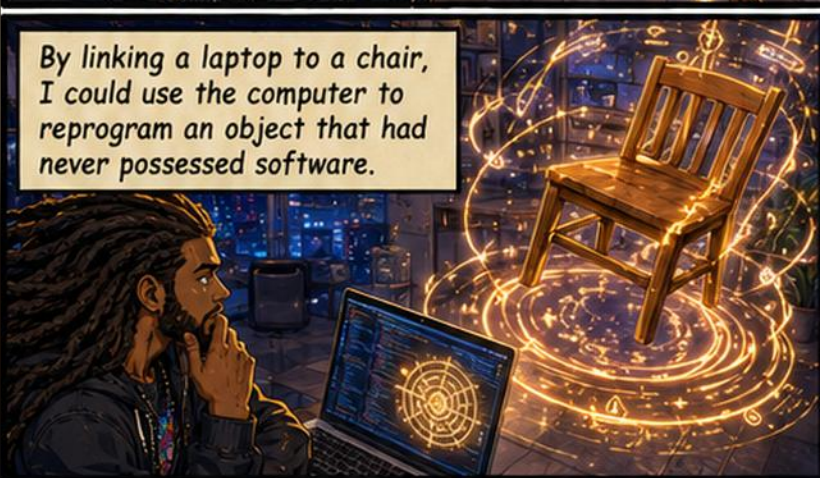
Then I reconsidered the Golden Energy Tether, whose abilities were less defined but far less limited.



Its true power was the creation of magical bonds between anything it connected.



By linking a laptop to a chair, I could use the computer to reprogram an object that had never possessed software.



The bond could remain after I removed the tether, allowing me to create another permanent connection somewhere else.



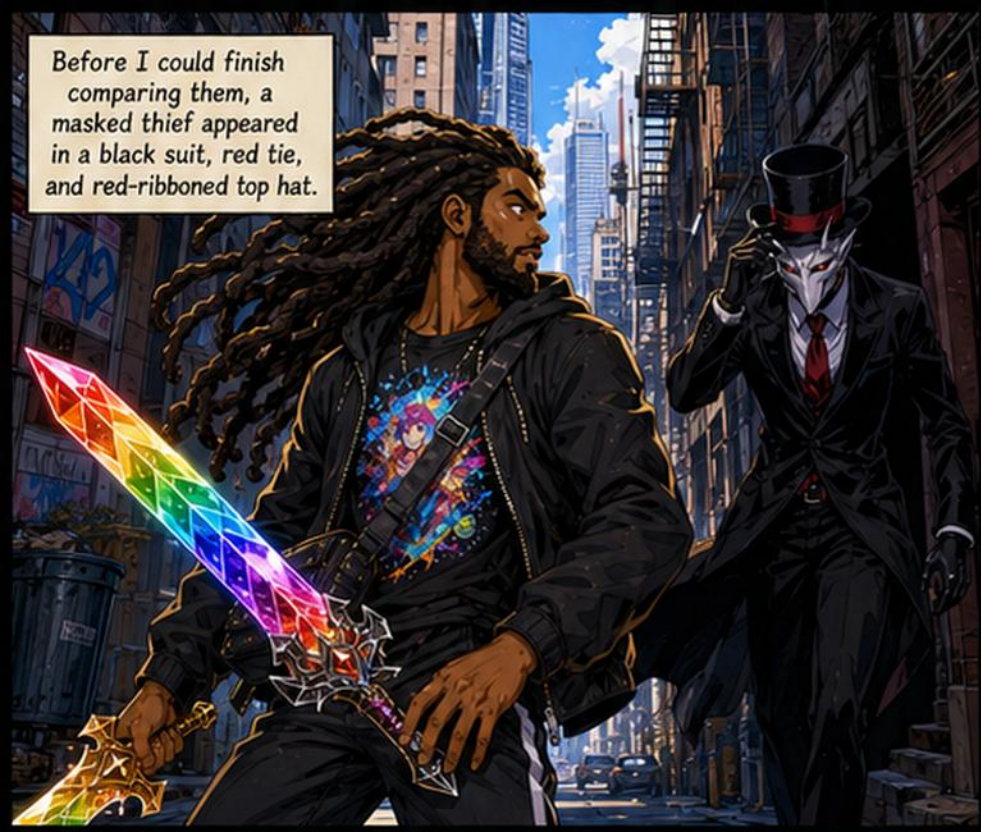
It also sensed my intentions, crossed any distance, caught every target, and carried me like a perfect grappling line.



Its limits depended less on fixed powers than on what existed around me and what I could imagine connecting.



Before I could finish comparing them, a masked thief appeared in a black suit, red tie, and red-ribboned top hat.



His porcelain-white demonic mask hid every trace of his face.

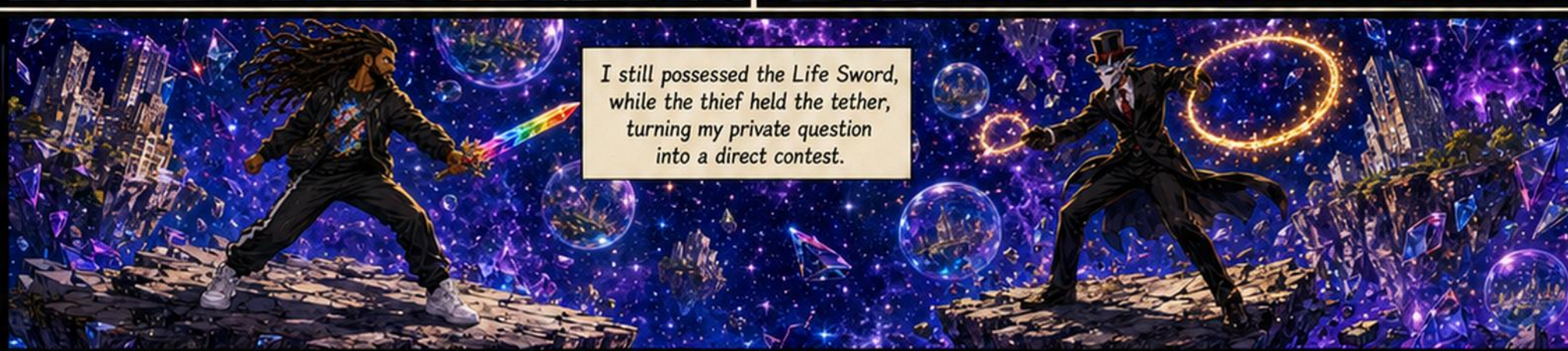


He seized the Golden Energy Tether from my hand.

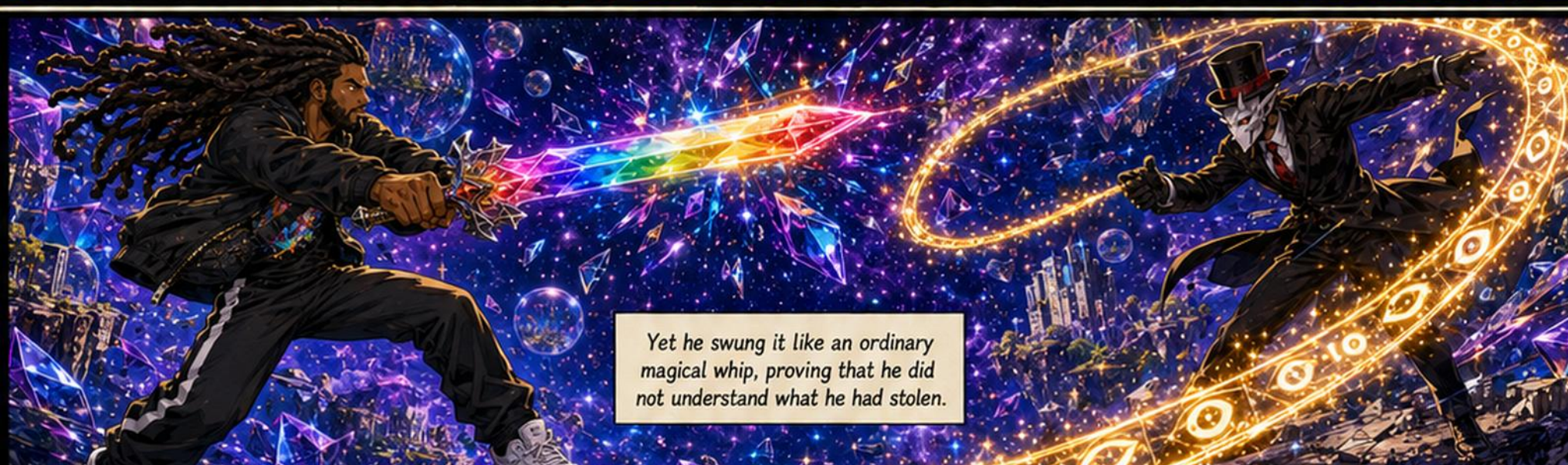
The modern city shattered, and we were carried into the open space of the Storyverse.



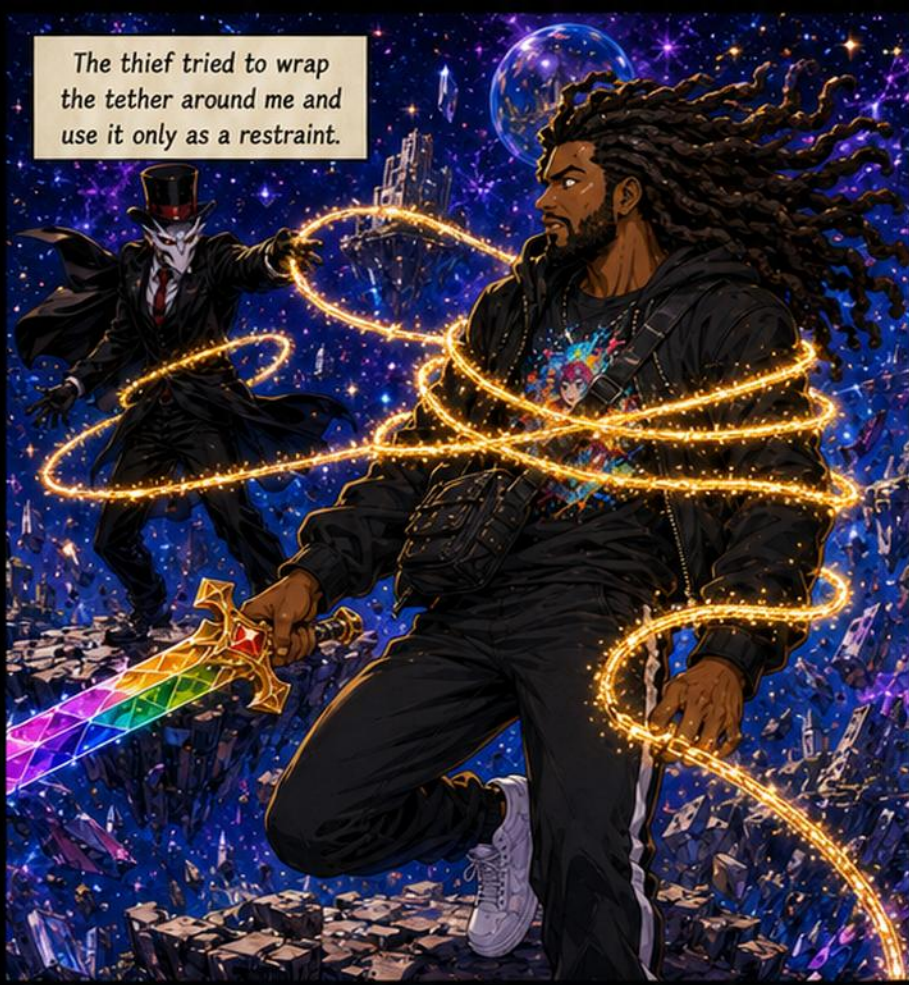
I still possessed the Life Sword, while the thief held the tether, turning my private question into a direct contest.



Yet he swung it like an ordinary magical whip, proving that he did not understand what he had stolen.



The thief tried to wrap the tether around me and use it only as a restraint.



I answered by cutting directly through Tetheron with Silonis.



The severed coils fell away, and I was free.



The thief celebrated because he believed he had tricked me into destroying one of my own greatest artifacts.



He thought I had sacrificed the tether simply to escape.



But I had never believed that the cut would be permanent.



I gathered every severed piece and charged before the thief could understand my plan.



Silonis did far more than cut. Its greatest power was the ability to channel life.



Warm rainbow energy entered the damaged tether, joined each broken end, and made the golden light whole again.



Then the restoration continued beyond simple repair.



The life energy awakened a presence within the tether, and it curled beside me with an intention unmistakably its own.



With both artifacts restored to me, the thief finally faced the power he had underestimated.



Tetheron formed a bond between him and the floating city fragment, while Silonis protected us from every counterattack.



Working together, they restrained and disarmed him without forcing me to destroy him.



I mocked his certainty that cutting the tether had meant losing it forever.



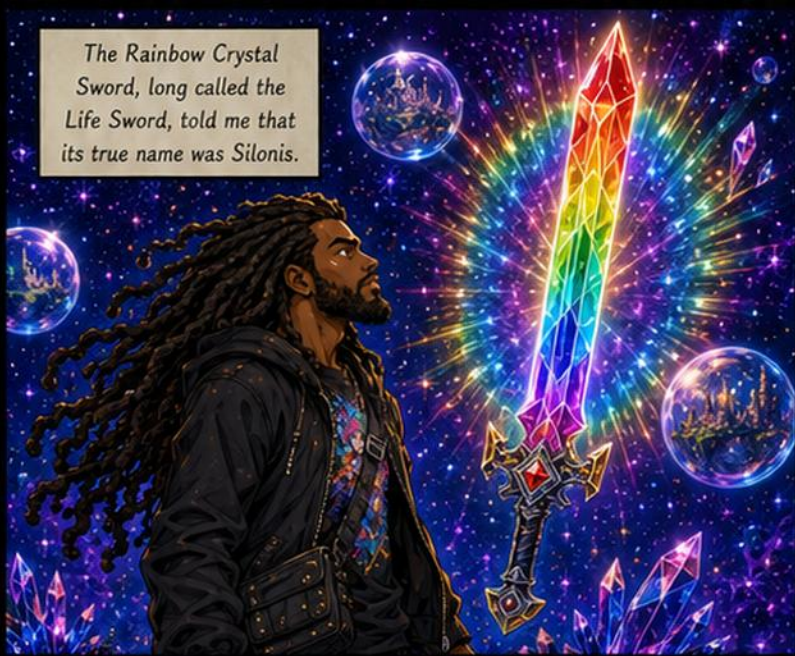
As the battle ended, I felt two living presences communicating through color, motion, and thought.



For the first time, the artifacts revealed the names by which they knew themselves.



The Rainbow Crystal Sword, long called the Life Sword, told me that its true name was Silonis.



The Golden Energy Tether revealed a name of its own: Tetheron.



I could not tell whether Tetheron had always hidden a quiet life or whether Silonis had awakened it during the restoration.



Silonis offered healing, protection, purification, animation, and flight.



Tetheron offered limitless possibilities through magical bonds and creative connection.



The choice was no longer about which object was better. Both were alive, both mattered to me, and both would continue exploring the Storyverse by my side.

